HDR DATASET NOTE

# German Breast Cancer Study Group trial 2 (GBSG-2)

HDR-DE-0001 | version 1.0.0 | 2026-11-02

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|---|---|
| DOI | Pending, minted at publication |
| CREATORS | Imad El Badisy |
| COVERAGE | Germany |
| PERIOD | 1984 to 1989 |
| UNIT | Patient |
| LICENCE | CC BY 4.0 |
| LANDING PAGE | https://elbadisyimad.com/hdr/datasets/de-gbsg2-breast-cancer-trial/ |

## Description

Patient records from the GBSG-2 randomised 2x2 trial of hormonal treatment and chemotherapy duration in node-positive breast cancer in Germany: tumour and patient characteristics with recurrence-free survival time.

A classic trial dataset for prognostic modelling in breast cancer.

GOOD FOR

- Prognostic modelling
- Teaching Cox regression

NOT GOOD FOR

- Treatment effects of modern therapies

## Origin

| | |
|---|---|
| ORGANISATION | German Breast Cancer Study Group |
| PUBLICATION | *Schumacher M et al. (1994). Randomized 2x2 trial evaluating hormonal treatment and the duration of chemotherapy in node-positive breast cancer patients. J Clin Oncol 12: 2086-2093* |
| COUNTRY | Germany |
| ADDRESS | https://doi.org/10.1200/JCO.1994.12.10.2086 |
| ACCESSED | 2026-11-02 |
| REUSE TERMS | Distributed openly for research in the TH.data R package (GPL-3). |
| HOW OBTAINED | Taken from the BioBench R package (dataset gbsg2), which took them from TH.data::GBSG2. Complete cases only (686 of 720 patients). |

## Files

| File | Content | Rows | Cols | Size |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `gbsg2.csv` | One row per patient | 686 | 10 | 26 kB |
| `de-gbsg2-breast-cancer-trial.xlsx` | All tables in one workbook, with About and Variables sheets | | | 39 kB |

SHA-256 checksums of every file are listed in `manifest.csv` on the landing page.

## Variables

**`gbsg2.csv`** One row per patient

| Variable | Type | Description |
|---|---|---|

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| `horTh` | string | Hormonal therapy (yes, no) |
| `age` | integer | Age (years) |
| `menostat` | string | Menopausal status (Pre, Post) |
| `tsize` | integer | Tumour size (mm) |
| `tgrade` | string | Tumour grade (I, II, III) |
| `pnodes` | integer | Number of positive lymph nodes |
| `progrec` | integer | Progesterone receptor (fmol) |
| `estrec` | integer | Oestrogen receptor (fmol) |
| `time` | integer | Recurrence-free survival time (days) |
| `cens` | integer | Event (1 recurrence or death, 0 censored) |

## Known issues

Read these before analysis.

1. **Demonstration entry.** Taken from the BioBench R package to show how HDR presents a dataset. It has not gone through HDR review and will be removed before launch.
2. **Complete cases only.** 34 patients with missing values were dropped by the source.

## How to cite

Imad El Badisy (2026). German Breast Cancer Study Group trial 2 (GBSG-2) (version 1.0.0) [Data set]. HDR: Health Data for Research. https://elbadisyimad.com/hdr/datasets/de-gbsg2-breast-cancer-trial/

Please also cite the origin: German Breast Cancer Study Group, Schumacher M et al. (1994). Randomized 2x2 trial evaluating hormonal treatment and the duration of chemotherapy in node-positive breast cancer patients. J Clin Oncol 12: 2086-2093.

## Versions

| Version | Date | Changes |
|---|---|---|
| 1.0.0 | 2026-11-02 | Demonstration release |

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